



Questionnaire: News Corp - 20% acquisition of National Distribution Services

MN-35014

Deadline to respond: 11 May 2026

The Australian Competition and Consumer Commission (ACCC) is currently assessing News Corp Australia Pty Ltd (**News Corp**)'s proposed acquisition (through its subsidiary, News Pty Ltd) of a 20% interest in National Distribution Services Pty Ltd (**NDS**) and a call option to acquire the remaining shares in National Distribution Services in limited circumstances (the **Acquisition**).

News Corp, through its Australian subsidiaries, currently contracts with a range of suppliers, including NDS, to distribute its print media publications across Australia to retailers and home delivery subscribers. News Corp also arranges for its suppliers to distribute certain third-party publishers' print media on a shared carriage basis.

NDS supplies distribution and logistics services to a range of publishers in Australia, including News Corp. NDS operates a distribution network covering Victoria, New South Wales, South Australia, Tasmania, Queensland and Darwin.

For further information about the ACCC's assessment of the Acquisition, see the ACCC's [Acquisitions Register](#).

The ACCC is assessing the impact of the Acquisition on competition and is seeking your views. The ACCC invites you to provide submissions or information in response to the questions below by **11 May 2026** via email to mergers@acc.gov.au with the title *Submission re: News Corp - National Distribution Services*. The ACCC must complete its assessment within strict statutory timelines which also impacts the time available for consultation.

If you would prefer to speak to a member of the ACCC case team, please email mergers@acc.gov.au with the title *Request for call re: News Corp - National Distribution Services*. Someone from the case team will contact you to find a suitable time for a call.

Please note that:

- This request is made in accordance with section 51ABZZD(2)(a) and (c) of the *Competition and Consumer Act 2010* (Cth) (the **Act**). This means that while the ACCC may take into account submissions or information received after the due date, it is not required to do so.
- In responding to the questions below or when providing a submission, please highlight and/or mark any confidential information and indicate why the information is confidential (as brief reasons in footnotes in your response or submission, or in a separate document such as the ACCC's [confidentiality claims template](#)). The standard terms on which the ACCC accepts confidential information are outlined at the end of this document.

Questions

1. Provide a brief description of your business or organisation, including any commercial relationships with News Corp and/or NDS.

Questions for print media publishers

2. To what extent do you compete with News Corp in the supply of print media publication services? Name your key competing publications and describe their relative importance to your business. If possible, provide estimated market shares (by revenue).

3. Explain who you consider to be NDS's main competitors in the supply of print media distribution services in the geographic areas where your print media is distributed.

4. Provide a brief description of the print media distribution services you acquire from NDS (including via any shared carriage arrangement with News Corp), including the estimated proportion of your business's print media distribution spend that is spent on these entities.

5. Explain whether the print media distribution services you acquire from NDS have substitutes from alternative suppliers (including self-supply of distribution services).
 - a. If so, please state who these alternative suppliers are and how they compare to NDS in terms of coverage, price and service quality.
 - b. If you consider there are no effective substitutes from alternative suppliers, what would be the likely effect of loss of access to NDS's print media distribution services on your business's readership and associated revenue?

6. Explain whether your business self-supplies print media distribution services, and describe any barriers you face to commencing or increasing self-supply.

Questions for suppliers of distribution services for print media

7. Describe the distribution services supplied by your business to print media publishers, including the geographic region(s) in Australia where you supply these services.

8. To what extent do you compete with NDS in the supply of distribution services to print media publishers? If possible, provide estimated market shares in each geographic region.

9. Provide a brief description of any distribution services you supply to News Corp for its print media, including the estimated proportion of your business's revenue that is generated from supplying these services to News Corp.

10. Explain whether News Corp's demand for your business's distribution services could be effectively replaced with demand from alternative customers (including customers from industries outside of print media publishing).
- a. If so, please state who these alternative customers are.
- b. If you lost News Corp as a customer and couldn't replace it with demand from other customers, what effect would this be likely to have on both your revenue and your costs?

Other

11. Provide any additional information or comments that you consider relevant to the ACCC's assessment of the Acquisition, including any views or concerns on the effect of the Acquisition on competition in Australia.

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Confidentiality of responses

During the ACCC's assessment of a notified acquisition, the ACCC may receive information that is properly regarded as being confidential, and which is provided to the ACCC in confidence. The ACCC is committed to treating this information responsibly and in accordance with the law. The ACCC understands the importance of confidentiality to parties involved in a notified acquisition, as well as to third parties that provide information to the ACCC.

The standard terms on which the ACCC accepts confidential information are:

- there is no restriction on the internal use, including future use, that the ACCC may make of the confidential information consistent with the ACCC's statutory functions
- confidential information may be disclosed to the ACCC's external advisors and consultants on condition that each such advisor or consultant will be informed of the obligation to treat the information as confidential, and
- the ACCC may disclose the confidential information to other third parties if compelled by law or in accordance with section 155AAA of the Act. This includes disclosures made in the performance of official duties or functions, which include transparency requirements which are part of the merger control regime.

For further information on confidentiality, see the ACCC's [interim merger process guidelines](#).